

Splinter Makes Web Application Testing Simple

Splinter makes acceptance testing of Web applications simpler by automating interactions with the browser. In Splinter, actions such as visiting a link, clicking on a particular component or links on the page can be automated with very few lines of code. This article provides insights into the world of automatic Web application testing using Splinter.



Automating the sequence of actions to be carried out when interacting with a browser is important in testing Web applications. The sequence of actions ranges from simply opening the Web page to see whether it is loading properly in a browser, to advanced activities such as iterating through all possible visual states of the Web page. There are many options when it comes to carrying out Web application testing, some of which are illustrated in Figure 1.

- **Selenium** enables the automation of tasks across many platforms with various browsers. Its key feature is the integration with many programming languages and testing frameworks (<http://docs.seleniumhq.org/>).
- **Mechanize** facilitates programmatic Web browsing using Python. It is the equivalent of the Perl Module WWW::Mechanize. Convenient link parsing and automatic observance of robots.txt are some of the key

highlights of Mechanize (<http://wwwsearch.sourceforge.net/mechanize/>).

- **Zope.testbrowser** is a programmable browser, which carries out functional testing of Web applications. Along with many other automation features, **Zope.testbrowser** provides performance related details such as how much time each request takes (<https://pypi.python.org/pypi/zope.testbrowser#performance-testing>).
- **Windmill**: The major features of the Windmill test framework are the cross-browser 'record, edit and playback', its interactive service shell, customisable proxy handling, and JavaScript test integration (<http://www.getwindmill.com/>).
- **PhantomJS** provides methods to perform headless website testing, capturing of screens, page automation, monitoring of page loading, etc (<http://phantomjs.org/>).